

China Dairy: Modern Dairy positive profit alert plus controlling stake on Shengmu; positive read across to Mengniu

What's new:

- **Modern Dairy (not covered)** issued a positive profit alert, guiding for 1H26 net profit of no less than Rmb43mn (vs. a Rmb972mn loss in 1H25), and this turnaround was mainly driven by i) lower fair value losses on dairy cows due to a decline in the number of culled cattle and an increase in the selling price of culled cattle, ii) stable raw milk gross margin with higher gross profit value, and iii) continued cost reduction and operating efficiency improvements. The Rmb43mn+ NP guided by Modern Dairy for 1H26 may imply a c.Rmb21mn associate income for Mengniu in 1H26 (based on its c.49% stake in Modern Dairy), already close to GSE's 2026 full year estimates at Rmb25mn (GSE of associate loss in 1H26 at -Rmb169mn).
- The company also announced that its mandatory cash offer for China Shengmu (China leading organic dairy company owning 34 farms and 144k dairy cows with c.2,169 tonnes of daily fresh milk production, per its 2025 annual report) has become unconditional in all respects on 20 July and the offer will remain open until Aug 3rd. Following the closing date on 21 July, Modern Dairy held c.81.17% of China Shengmu shares with 1) c.49.9% of all issued shares accepted until 21 Jul, 2) plus 29.99% shares holding pre-acquisition by Mengniu and additional c.1.28% shares acquired on Oct 2025. Once the deal is completed with all free float accepted, Mengniu's associate income from Shengmu will potentially increase through its c.49% stake in Modern Dairy.

We view the pending acquisition as offering potential positive read-across to Mengniu (it owns c.49% of Modern Dairy equity interest as of Jun 2026), due to the potential for operating synergies for Modern Dairy and foreseeable higher direct exposure of Mengniu to a larger premium raw milk resources base in the near future.

The authors would like to thank Lily Qi for her contribution to this report.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Mengniu Dairy

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Mengniu. Our 12-month TP of HK\$24.0 is based on a 15.1x 2027E P/E discounted back to mid-2027 with a 9.6% COE.

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Key downside risks: 1) Slower-than-expected premium demand; 2) Slower-than-expected dairy demand recovery; 3) More intense dairy industry competition; 4) Wider losses in new categories.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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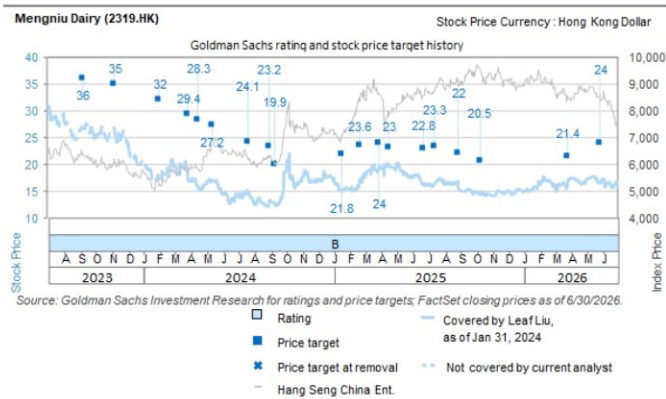
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Mengniu Dairy (2319.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
27-May-26	24.00	16.45
26-Mar-26	21.40	16.32
08-Oct-25	20.50	14.24
28-Aug-25	22.00	15.84
14-Jul-25	23.30	16.36
22-Jun-25	22.80	16.32
16-Apr-25	23.00	19.76
27-Mar-25	24.00	19.50
20-Feb-25	23.60	16.58
16-Jan-25	21.80	14.98
10-Sep-24	19.90	12.42
29-Aug-24	23.20	13.18
19-Jul-24	24.10	14.50
12-May-24	27.20	16.96
15-Apr-24	28.30	15.80
27-Mar-24	29.40	17.08
31-Jan-24	32.00	17.24
06-Nov-23	35.00	26.75
06-Sep-23	36.00	26.65

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